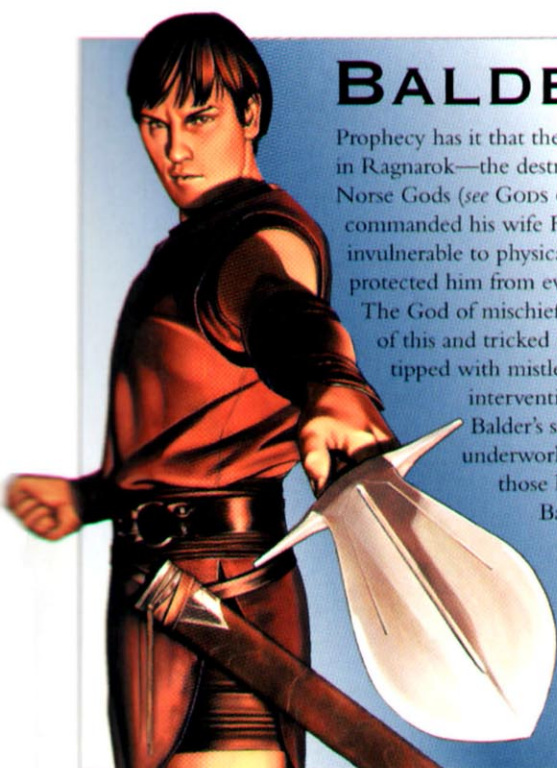




BALDER THE BRAVE

Prophecy has it that the death of Norse God Balder will result in Ragnarok—the destruction of Asgard, the home of the Norse Gods (see GODS OF ASGARD). For this reason Odin commanded his wife Frigga to make Balder (his son) invulnerable to physical injury and so she cast spells that protected him from everything except mistletoe.

The God of mischief, Loki, Thor's adopted brother, learned of this and tricked the blind God Hoder to fire an arrow, tipped with mistletoe wood, at Balder. Only Odin's intervention saved him, but before his recovery, Balder's soul was to travel through the underworld where it encountered the spirits of those he had killed.

Balder's return to the land of the living was not without difficulties: he fell into a deep depression after Nanna, his beloved, sacrificed herself to save him from marrying the Norn sorceress Kamilla. Roving the desert, determined to kill himself, Balder gained hope from a vision of the future. Since then, he has come to love Kamilla, with whom he fought against Surtur and the legions of the Muspelheim. He also ruled Asgard when Odin was believed dead, but following the God-ruler's return Balder went back to his new love, Kamilla. **AD**



A natural leader, Balder the Brave has led his people on countless campaigns.

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Balder

OCCUPATION

Norse God of Light

BASE

Asgard

HEIGHT 6 ft 4 in

WEIGHT 320 lbs

EYES Blue

HAIR White

FIRST APPEARANCE

Journey into Mystery #85
(October 1962)

Charismatic leader; formidable swordsman, horseman, and hand-to-hand combatant; in Asgard dimension, only weapons tipped with mistletoe cause him harm; able to produce and emit light; possesses superhuman strength, endurance, and longevity.

BALDER THE BRAVE

POWERS

BANNER, BETTY see opp. page

BANNER, DR. BRIAN

FIRST APPEARANCE *The Incredible Hulk* Vol. 2 #312 (Oct. 1985)

REAL NAME Brian Banner

OCCUPATION Atomic physicist **BASE** Dayton, Ohio

HEIGHT 5 ft 10 in **WEIGHT** 145 lbs **EYES** Brown **HAIR** Brown

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Scientific genius.



Married to his childhood sweetheart, Rebecca, Dr. Banner worked as an atomic physicist for the US government and helped develop the country's first atomic weapons. The more he studied atomic radiation,

the more he feared it. Suspecting that he had been exposed to trace amounts of radiation, Banner was horrified when he learned that his young wife was pregnant. When she began to suffer complications, he became convinced that the child would be mutant and grow up to become a monster. His paranoia increased when his son Bruce (see HULK) showed signs of great intelligence. Banner began to drink heavily and often exploded in fits of temper. After striking and accidentally killing his wife, he was convicted of manslaughter and confined to a mental institution. His son Bruce would be profoundly affected by this family trauma. **TD**

BANSHEE

After his wife's death, Irish Interpol agent and mutant Sean Cassidy was forced to join Factor Three, an organization of evil mutants. The evil CHANGELING gave him the name Banshee and fitted him with an explosive headband to keep him in line. PROFESSOR X used his telepathic powers to remove the band, and Banshee then defeated Factor Three. Later, Banshee joined the X-MEN. While there, he reunited with his daughter Stryn and became co-head—with Emma Frost—of Xavier's Academy, where he taught the young mutants of GENERATION X.

Following the tragic death of his beloved, Dr. Moira MacTaggart, Banshee suffered a temporary breakdown. He formed X-CORPS, but this venture ended with MYSTIQUE stabbing him through the throat. Banshee later died at the hands of

VULCAN. **MT, MF**

Banshee unleashes a devastating sonic scream at Cyclops and his fellow X-Men.



FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Sean Cassidy

OCCUPATION

Director of X-Corps

BASE

Cassidy Keep, Ireland

HEIGHT 6 ft

WEIGHT 170 lbs

EYES Blue-green

HAIR Blond

FIRST APPEARANCE

Uncanny X-Men #28
(January 1967)

Banshee's "sonic scream" could propel him into flight, shatter solid objects, and fire percussive blasts, which placed others into trances or knocked them unconscious.

BANSHEE

POWERS

